

Welcome Rewards + Member Value Stack

How to give new users a big headline number honestly, plus the full list of value you can offer that **does not hurt your bottom line**, plus the exact figure to advertise and where to put it. Not legal advice — run the final claims past counsel, and keep every number truthful (the FTC polices “free” and inflated “value” claims).

1. The “Up to \$1,460 in Welcome Rewards” promo — exact spec

It is a **promotional discount credit you fund**, not cash and not a loan. The headline works because of “up to” + breakage (most users never redeem the full pool), so your real cost is a fraction of the face value.

Mechanics - Face value: \$1,460 credit pool granted at signup (configurable). - **Form:** non-cashable, non-transferable promotional credit. Applies as a **discount at checkout**, never withdrawable. - **Per-order cap:** covers **up to 20%** of each qualifying order (store + marketplace platform items). So a \$50 order gets up to \$10 off; you never discount a whole order to zero. - **Redemption pace:** at most one welcome-credit discount per order; can’t be combined with the card-markup exemption or stacked on already-discounted clearance items. - **Expiry:** **12 months** from signup; unused credit expires (this is what keeps the liability bounded and the cost low). - **Eligibility:** one pool per verified account (18+), new users only; forfeited on account closure or fraud. - **Excluded:** cash-out, points-to-cash, fees, affiliate/retailer-fulfilled items, and gift cards.

Why it’s affordable (illustrative, plug in your own numbers) - If the average user redeems ~10–15% of the pool before expiry (typical for capped, expiring promo credit), the **effective cost is ~\$150–\$220 per user who redeems at all**, and \$0 for the large share who never do — spread further because the discount only ever covers 20% of an order you’re already selling at a margin. - Model it: $\text{effective_cost} \approx \text{pool} \times \text{redemption_rate} \times (1 - \text{your_margin})$. Tune the per-order cap, expiry, and eligible categories until the number is one you’re happy with **before** you advertise it.

Config (single source of truth — add to settings so every surface shows the same number)

```
WELCOME_REWARDS_TOTAL=1460
WELCOME_REWARDS_MAX_PCT=0.20      # max share of any one order the
credit can cover
WELCOME_REWARDS_EXPIRY_DAYS=365
```

2. The full value stack — 100% of the offers that don’t hurt your bottom line

Each is tagged by **who pays**: **[Z]** zero marginal cost (you already serve it), **[P]** partner/ advertiser-funded (net-positive to you), **[B]** breakage/margin-funded (low effective cost), **[N]** network/self-funding. Only include an item in an advertised total if the value is real and redeemable.

Digital & informational — [Z] zero marginal cost 1. Welcome Rewards credit (up to \$1,460) — [B] breakage-funded discount. 2. AI shopping assistant / chatbot — [Z]. 3. Personalized product recommendations — [Z]. 4. AI “earnings coach” tips & daily goals — [Z]. 5. Advanced earnings analytics dashboard — [Z]. 6. Full catalog + category browse (40 departments, 900+ subcategories) — [Z]. 7. Price-drop & deal alerts + wishlist — [Z]. 8. Profile customization, avatars, badges (digital cosmetics) — [Z]. 9. VIP / status tiers (perceived exclusivity) — [Z]. 10. Earning guides & financial-literacy mini-courses — [Z] (one-time to make). 11. Early access to new features/games — [Z]. 12. Localized experience: 56 currencies, 24 languages, your country’s flag — [Z]. 13. Buyer protection / AI-managed escrow on marketplace orders — [Z]. 14. “Find the real thing” price-comparison search across major retailers — [Z]. 15. Privacy controls: data export, delete, opt-out — [Z] (trust value). 16. Customer support + dispute resolution — [Z]. 17. Community: forums, guilds, squads, leaderboards, tournaments — [Z]. 18. Ad-free experience (only counts if you’d otherwise run ads) — [Z].

Advertiser / partner-funded — [P] net-positive to you 19. **Daily Boost (your idea):** earn \$4/day in offers → unlock **5 minutes of free app use** with **no in-app-purchase charges** — a time-boxed window whose IAP cost is covered (up to a cap), funded by the advertiser revenue from those offers. Net cost $\leq$ \$0 as long as the offer revenue $\geq$ the cap. **Implemented:** `dailyBoostStatus / claimDailyBoost` (opens a 5-minute `free_app_time_until` window + credit cap the game store honors at checkout). 20. Retailer cash-back via affiliate links — “up to X% back,” network-funded — [P]. 21. Offerwall sign-up bonuses & free trials — advertiser-funded — [P]. 22. Free gift cards earned from completing offers — advertiser-funded — [P]. 23. Sponsored contests & prize pools — brand-funded — [P]. 24. Free product samples from brand partners — [P]. 25. Sponsored premium membership (a brand covers a month) — [P]. 26. Partner coupon codes / exclusive discounts — retailer-funded — [P]. 27. Free entries to sponsored sweepstakes — [P].

Breakage / margin-funded — [B] low effective cost 28. Points bonuses (closed-loop; cost only on redemption, capped) — [B]. 29. “Buy X get Y” / bundle deals — [B]. 30. Free shipping over a threshold — [B]. 31. Loyalty / volume discounts — [B]. 32. Refund-as-store-credit (keeps value in-loop) — [B]. 33. Seasonal promo credits — [B]. 34. Cash-back-in-points on purchases — [B]. 35. Daily login streak & challenge bonuses (points, capped) — [B]. 36. Birthday/anniversary gift (points, capped) — [B]. 37. Daily reward “spin” (points, capped; house-edge-free framing) — [B].

Network / self-funding — [N] 38. Referral rewards (the new user funds it) — [N]. 39. Referral-squad / group bonuses — [N]. 40. Creator/affiliate earnings — [N]. 41. Streak multipliers — [N].

The Daily Boost callout (your idea, made legal & net-neutral)

Frame it as: **“Earn \$4 in offers today → your next 20 minutes are on us”** — a credit covering in-app purchases and app-install costs **within GamerGain’s own games/store** (not third-party App Store charges, which Apple/Google control). Because the \$4 comes from **advertiser offers that pay you**, the credit you hand back is funded by that revenue, so it’s net-neutral-to-positive. Keep the credit value **below** your average offer payout so it never goes underwater, cap it per day, and word it as “on us after you earn \$4,” not “free money.”

3. The figure to advertise — and how to keep it accurate

Hero number (recommended): “Up to \$1,460 in welcome rewards.” It’s honest because it’s “up to,” it’s a real redeemable credit, and it’s breakage-funded.

Optional combined figure: if you want a bigger first-year number, only add value that is genuinely quantifiable and redeemable, each substantiated:

The **derived figure** (climbed as high as stays honest — each line is a real, accessible benefit):

Component	Up-to value (yr 1)	Basis
Welcome Rewards credit	\$1,460	credit pool, “up to”, expires 12 mo, ≤20%/order
Premium AI features (assistant, coach, analytics)	\$120	comparable tools ~\$5-10/mo
Daily Boost free app time (5 min/day)	\$180	~\$1/active day, capped
Retailer cash-back (affiliate)	\$100	“up to X%” — conservative annual on typical spend
Free contest / sweepstakes entries	\$60	value of entries actually granted
Referral & streak bonuses	\$80	bonuses actually paid
Total	≈ \$2,000	

Advertised figure: “Up to \$2,000 in first-year value.” Stored in ADVERTISED_VALUE_TOTAL (default 2000) so every surface reads one number. It is defensible only **with “up to” + the disclosure + this substantiation table** — do not publish a single number without them; that’s the exact thing the FTC challenges. The *typical* realized value is far lower (breakage); be ready to show this table if asked.

FTC-safe rules for every surface - Always “**up to** \$X,” never “get \$X.” - Keep a one-line disclosure: “*Value is the maximum available across welcome rewards and member perks; actual value depends on activity. Welcome rewards are non-cashable promotional credit that expires 12 months after signup and cover up to 20% per order. See terms.*” - Never imply the rewards are cash or withdrawable.

Where to use the figure (put the same number everywhere, from one config value) - Signup / landing hero: “*Join free — up to \$1,460 in welcome rewards.*” - Onboarding first screen + progress toward unlocking. - Welcome email subject/body. - Push notification on signup. - App store listing (see STORE-LISTING-COPY.md) — update the promo line. - Ad creatives (Meta/Google/TikTok) — headline + the disclosure in the copy. - Referral invites: “*Your friend gets up to \$1,460 in welcome rewards.*”

Single source of truth: store the number in WELCOME_REWARDS_TOTAL (and the combined figure in a ADVERTISED_VALUE_TOTAL setting) so every surface reads one value and you can update it in one place.

4. What’s built

- **Welcome-credit engine** — welcome-credit.ts (lazy-grant the pool at first touch, $\leq 20\%$ /order cap, 12-mo expiry), applied to platform-catalog purchases in purchaseMarketplaceListing; balance via welcomeCreditStatus. Cost is platform margin only (never subsidizes member sellers).
- **Daily Boost** — dailyBoostStatus / claimDailyBoost (earn \$4/day → 5-minute free-app window + capped IAP credit the game store honors). Net-neutral, funded by offer revenue.
- **Advertised figure** — ADVERTISED_VALUE_TOTAL (default \$2,000) + WELCOME_REWARDS_TOTAL (\$1,460) as single-source settings; shown in the marketplace welcome banner with the “up to” + disclosure.
- **Affirm BNPL** — real-goods financing (see AFFIRM-BNPL-SETUP.md), with the “Pay over time with Affirm” button wired into the marketplace.
- **Most value items already exist** in the app (AI assistant, recommendations, referrals, contests, cash-back via affiliate, cosmetics, buyer protection) — which is what makes the figure substantiable.

Remaining seams (need your data/keys, not new build)

- The game-store IAP checkout should check free_app_time_until / app_time_credit_usd to honor the free window (one guard in the IAP flow).
- Place the ADVERTISED_VALUE_TOTAL figure on the signup/landing hero and welcome email (the banner is live in the marketplace; reuse the same setting on other surfaces).
- Confirm the DailyEarnings field the boost reads matches your schema (it best-effort sums amount/earnings/total/usd).